12 BDD in the build process

This chapter covers

- Executable specifications and the automated build process
- The role of BDD in continuous integration (CI) and continuous delivery
- Using a CI server to publish living documentation
- Using a CI server to speed up your automated acceptance tests

The ultimate aim of BDD is to deliver more valuable software with less waste. But the business value of a new feature isn't truly realized until it's deployed into production for users to use. So if you want to deliver business value to users faster, you need to be able to deploy features quickly and efficiently.

Deploying a feature into production is typically a fairly complicated process. You need to build the application from source code and run the automated unit, integration, and acceptance tests. You need to bundle it up into a deployable package. You may do performance tests, code quality checks, and so forth. And you'll typically deploy it into a test or UAT environment for testers and users to verify before deploying it into production.